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Razorpay is India's first full-stack financial solutions company

“Focus on the challenge of each customer”

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What was the problem you were grappling with?

In the initial days of founding Razorpay, my Co-founder (Harshil Mathur) and I developed a digital fee payment system for schools. For months, we pitched the idea, only to face repeated rejections. Only one school agreed to try our product, which was deeply discouraging. We lacked a business network. The rejections tested our resolve and confidence.

Whom did you approach for advice and why?

In those challenging moments, my Co-founder and I leaned on each other for support. Without mentors or a strong business network, we became each other's sounding board. At that time, Razorpay was operating out of Startup Oasis, a Jaipur-based incubation centre. While we were still refining our payments gateway solution, a few start-ups from the incubation centre began using our product. The feedback from these fellow founders and early supporters of Razorpay was invaluable.

What was the advice you received?

Through our interactions with early customers, we realised that true growth comes from genuinely solving customers' pain points, not just chasing the largest market segments. Their feedback taught us to focus on understanding and addressing the unique challenges of each customer.

How effective was it in resolving the problem?

What we learnt from our early challenges was the importance of building a strong foundation with our first 100 customers. This realisation shifted our approach entirely. Instead of chasing scale, we focussed on deeply engaging with our early customers, continuously refining our platform based on their feedback. A turning point came in 2015 when we were accepted into the Y Combinator programme. This brought much-needed validation, mentorship, and resources. **BT**

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